

Qingchuan (Tony) Yang

📍 Los Angeles, CA ✉ qcyang@usc.edu 🌐 noiseboi.github.io 🔗 qingchuan-yang 🗣 noiseboi

Education

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| Ph.D. University of Southern California , Computer Science
• Advised by Prof. Sai Praneeth Karimireddy | Los Angeles, CA
Aug 2025 – present |
| M.S. University of Chicago , Statistics
• Advised by Prof. Haifeng Xu
• Advanced Scholars Program | Chicago, IL
Sept 2024 – June 2025 |
| B.S. University of Chicago , Computer Science (with Honors), Statistics
• Cum Laude | Chicago, IL
Sept 2020 – June 2024 |

Experience

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| University of Southern California , Graduate Research Assistant
• Developed EPSVec (ICML 2026), a method for efficient and private synthetic data generation via representation engineering.
• Work on the foundations of trustworthy AI, including the decision-making capabilities of LLM agents and alignment-focused sampling mechanisms. | Los Angeles, CA
Sept 2025 – present
10 months |
| Sooth Labs , Research Intern
• Hosted by Dr. Russ Salakhutdinov and Dr. Yaser Sheikh.
• Developing a state-of-the-art agent harness for long-horizon event forecasting. | May 2026 – Aug 2026
4 months |
| University of Chicago , Undergraduate Research Assistant
• Led the development of Prophet Arena (ICLR 2026), a live prediction benchmark evaluating LLMs' ability to retrieve and aggregate evidence for probabilistic forecasting.
• Featured by The Atlantic , Yahoo Finance , and The Dispatch . | Chicago, IL
June 2024 – Aug 2025
1 year 3 months |
| Amazon Web Services (AWS) , Software Development Intern
• Built an account resource termination pipeline for AWS accounts with fraudulent activity, saving \$11M in the first six months of deployment.
• Implemented a proactive security module for account operations with multi-stage integration tests; received a return offer. | June 2023 – Sept 2023
4 months |

Publications

LLM-as-a-Prophet: Understanding Predictive Intelligence with Prophet Arena

Qingchuan (Tony) Yang, *Simon Mahns*, Sida Li, *Anri Gu*, Jibang Wu, Haifeng Xu
arxiv.org/abs/2510.17638 (ICLR 2026)

EPSVec: Efficient and Private Synthetic Data Generation via Data Vectors

Amin Banayeeanzade, *Qingchuan (Tony) Yang*, Deqing Fu, Spencer Hong, Erin Babinsky, Alf Samuel, Anoop Kumar, Robin Jia, Sai Praneeth Karimireddy
arxiv.org/abs/2602.21218 (ICML 2026)

Sampling More, Getting Less: Calibration is the Diversity Bottleneck in LLMs

Amin Banayeeanzade, *Qingchuan (Tony) Yang*, Dhruv Tarsadiya, Fatemeh Bahrani, Leonardo Blas, Robin Jia, Meisam Razaviyayn, Sai Praneeth Karimireddy
arxiv.org/abs/2605.11128 (In submission)

Psychological Steering via Calibrated Activation Injections

Leonardo Blas, Qingchuan (Tony) Yang, Robin Jia, Emilio Ferrara
(In submission)

Honors

- USC Viterbi School of Engineering Fellowship (2025–2026)
- UChicago Dean's List (2020–2021, 2023–2024)

Academic Service

- Reviewer, NeurIPS 2026